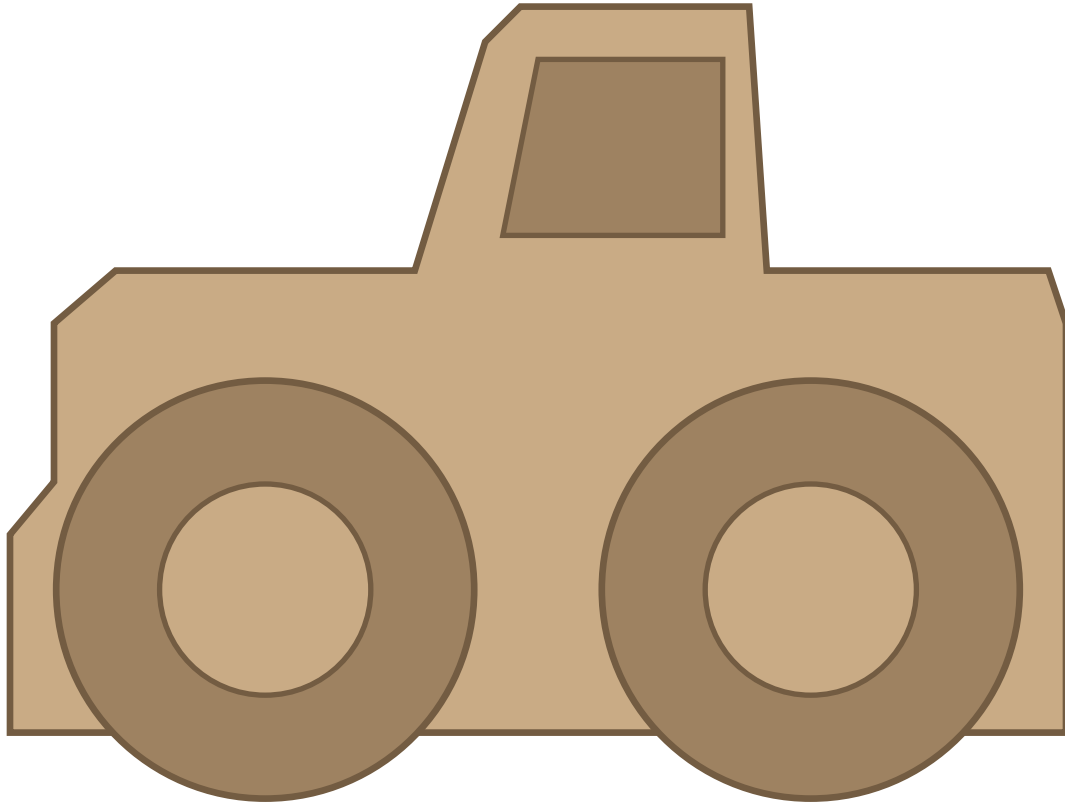




CARDBOARD MONSTER TRUCK

step by step guide



MEASURE TWICE • CUT ONCE • HAVE FUN

Cardboard Studio — our family workshop



What you need

MATERIALS

- Corrugated cardboard — a LOT (about 6 large boxes; the core alone is 24 layers)
- Wood glue or white glue (a big bottle)
- Two 1/4-inch wooden dowels, 7.5 inches long
- Paint or markers for flames and mud splatter

HARDWARE

- 1/4-inch wooden dowel, 7.5 inches long x2 — craft store, hardware store, or the garage

TOOLS

- Craft knife and spare blades (grown-up job!)
- Metal ruler
- Pencil
- Awl or 5/16-inch drill bit for the axle holes (grown-up job!)
- Saw or strong snips to cut the dowels (grown-up job!)
- Printer + tape for the template

FINISHED SIZE

12" x 9.15"

DIFFICULTY

3 of 3

BUILD TIME

2-3 hours (plus glue drying overnight)

AGES

6+ with a grown-up

SAFETY: Craft knives and hot glue are for grown-ups. Kids trace, fold, tape and decorate!



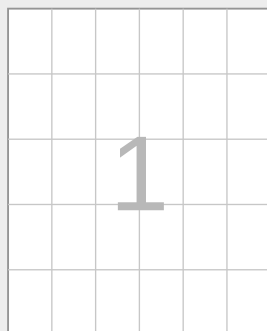
Paper size

INTERNATIONAL (EUROPEAN)

A4



210 x 297 mm
8-1/4 x 11-3/4 in



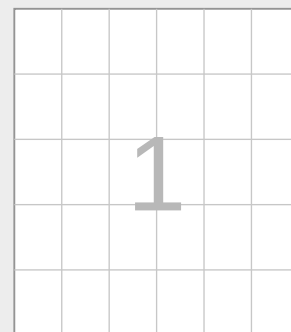
Template part has more height

NORTH AMERICA

Letter size



8.5 x 11 in
216 x 279 mm



Template part has more width



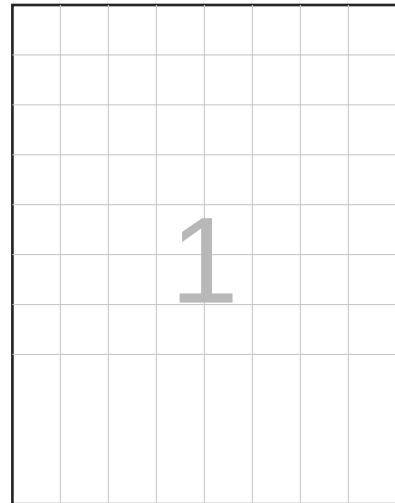
Be sure your printer
is set to print in 100%
ACTUAL SIZE



Print

Page Sizing & Handling

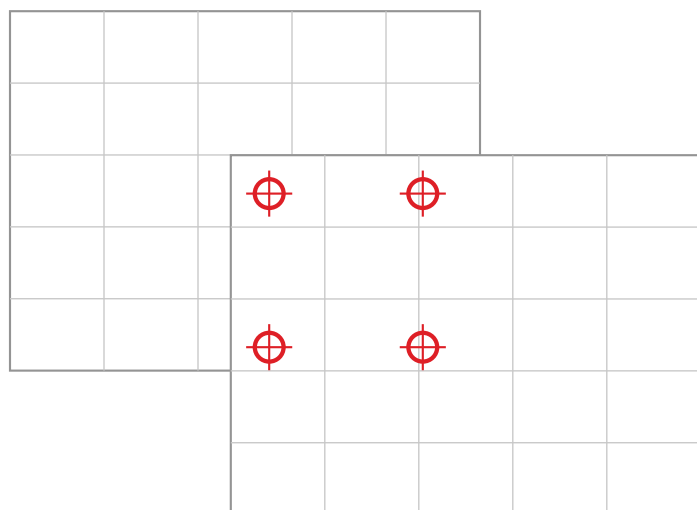
- ☐ Fit
- ☒ **Actual size** ✓
- ☐ Shrink oversized pages
- ☐ Custom Scale: 100%



Page 1 of 8

By default settings the printer shrinks the image to fit its printing area and your template will come out smaller. Each printer has its own paper margin and will not print right to the edge — that is OK: every page includes extra overlap so no detail is lost.

Pages overlap and positioning



① **Overlap**

All pages include an extra margin for overlap, so no details of the template are lost. The exact overlap depends on your printer.

② **1 inch grid (2.54 cm) / 3 inch grid (7.62 cm)**

The grid helps you align the pages perfectly in place. Light lines are 1 inch apart; heavy lines are 3 inches apart.

③ **3x3 inch square**

Overlap the pages until the visible squares measure exactly 1 inch and the heavy lines form 3x3 inch squares — your pattern will automatically align. Tape the pages together.

Your template pages arrange like this:



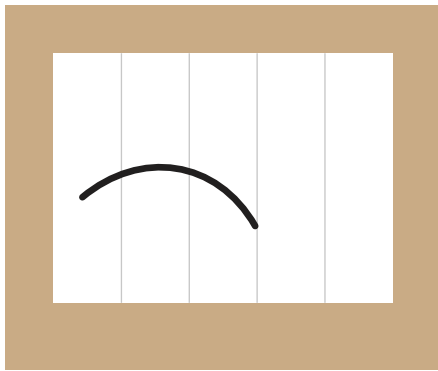
LINE UP THE GRID — THEN TAPE THE PAGES

Tracing

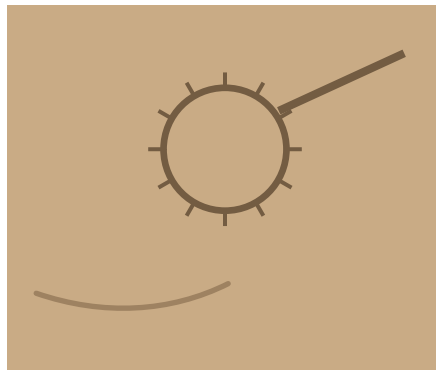
Method 1.

1. Cut Out the Template: carefully cut out the shapes from the printed template using scissors.
2. Secure the Template: place the template pieces on the cardboard and secure with tape or small weights so nothing slips.
3. Trace the Outline: use a pencil or pen to trace around the edges of the template onto the cardboard.
4. Check Your Lines: double-check every piece is traced before removing the template.

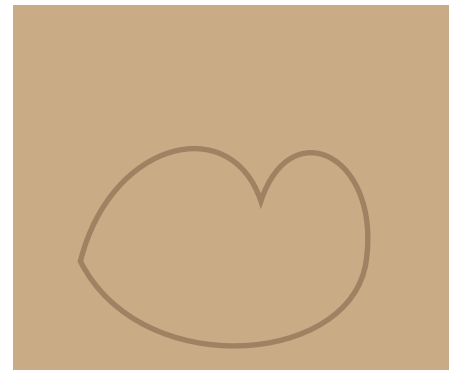
Method 2.



- ① Tape it
and trace it



- ② Tracing tool
a pen with pressure, or a tracing
wheel



- ③ Ready to cut out

NOTE - mind cardboard structure direction

The arrow on each template part shows the direction of the corrugated cardboard flutes. Keep the arrow parallel to the little waves inside your cardboard — parts stay strong and bend where they should.

Tip: the best way to bend cardboard smoothly is to cut slits halfway through on one side. Crease the slits with your fingernail to bend the other way and keep the front smooth.





NOTE - tips and tricks



HOW TO CUT CARDBOARD

PERFECT STRAIGHT CUT

Use a sharp blade and a metal ruler. Cut in 2–3 light passes instead of one hard press.

CUT A PAPER BLEED

Measure your cardboard thickness, cut half through, then peel off the corrugated layer leaving one paper face. Glue sticks much better on the bleed.

CUT A PERFECT CIRCLE

Mark the radius on a cardboard scrap, poke a pin through one end and a pencil through the other — instant compass. Cut just outside the line, then trim.



HOW TO GLUE CARDBOARD

QUICK CONNECTION — HOT GLUE

Fix the panels with tape first, open the joint like a book, run hot glue in the groove, close and tape again. Quick and sturdy for small parts.

BIG PANELS — WHITE GLUE

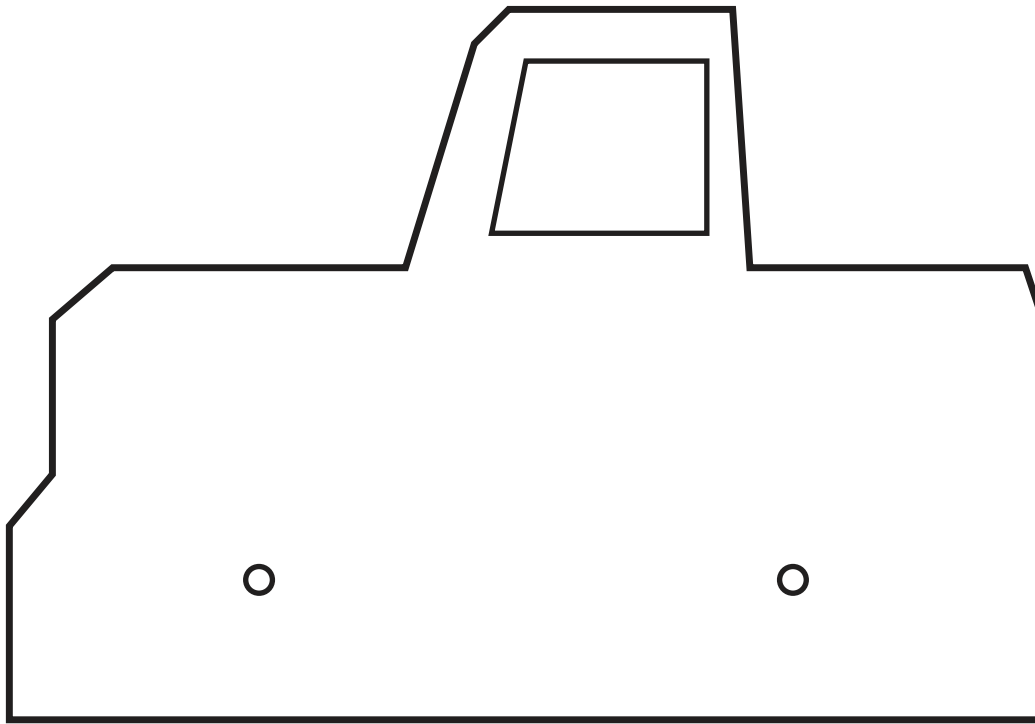
Add a little water to white glue and mix. Spread on the bottom part, lay the top parts like a mosaic so they overlap seams, press under books and let dry completely.

SEAMLESS OVERLAP

Make a paper bleed on the edges, apply white glue on the bottom part and the bleed, connect the matching parts, press and let dry.



Step 1. Print, tape and trace



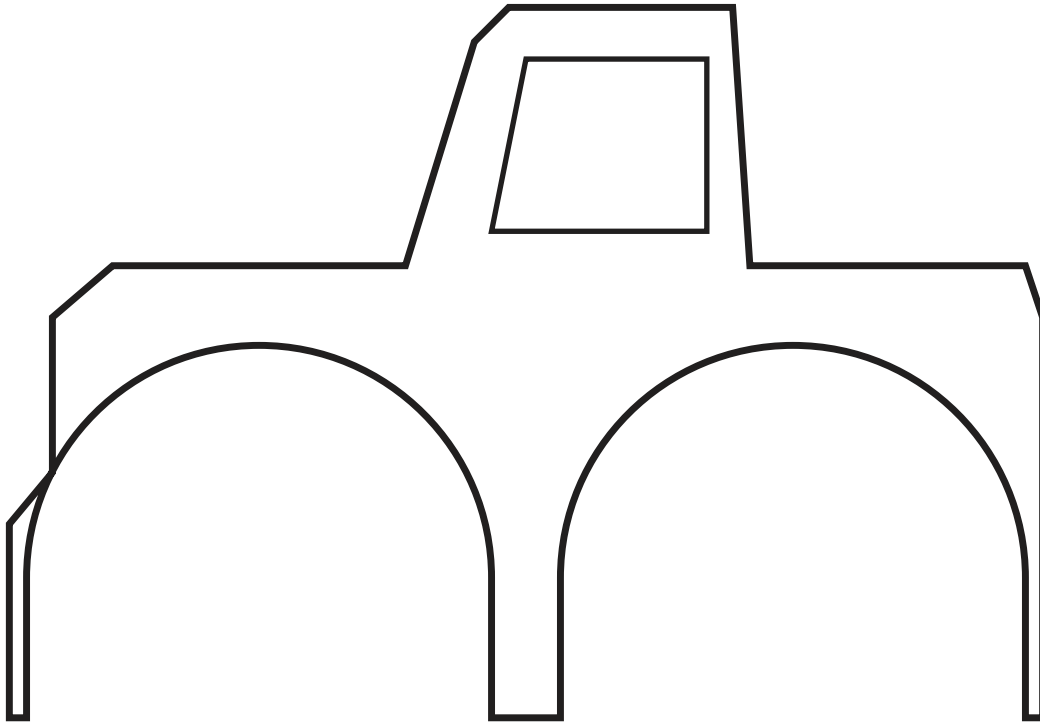
① Truck Body Core — trace this 24 times. Yes, 24!

1. Print at 100% actual size and tape the pages together on the grid lines.
2. Trace 24 Body Cores, 2 Truck Sides, 36 Wheel Discs, 4 Wheel Faces, 2 Bumper Plates and 1 Light Bar.
3. Line the corrugation arrow up with the flutes inside the cardboard every time.

TIP: Cut ONE Body Core first, then use it as a stencil for the other 23 — much faster than tracing.



Step 2. Cut, score and punch the holes

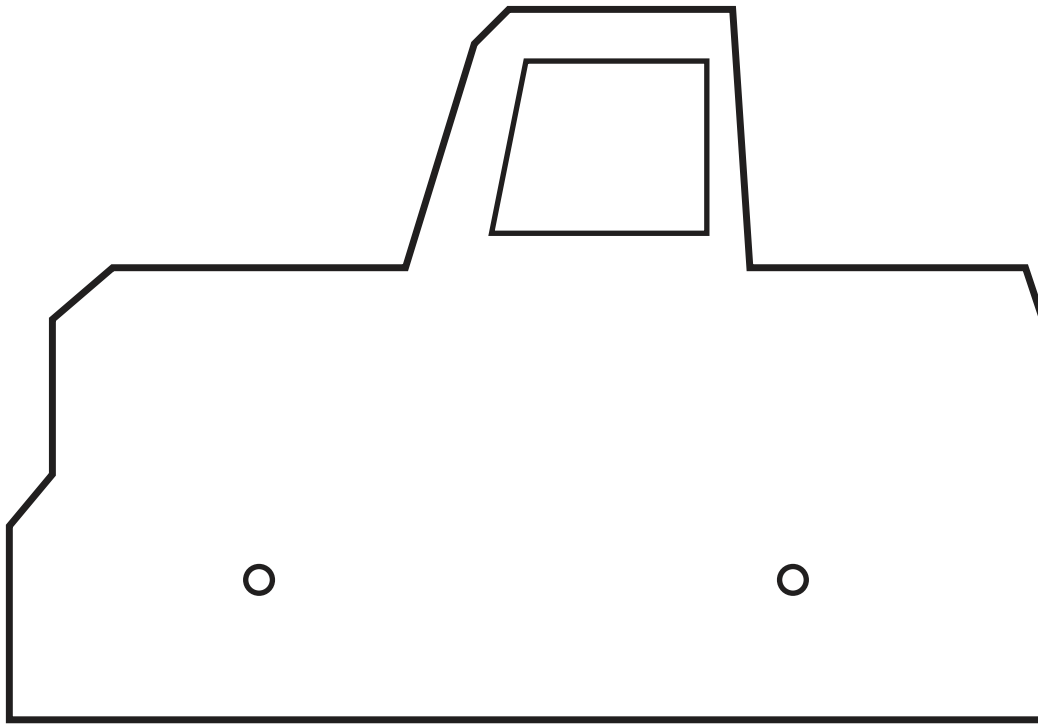


① Truck Side — the big wheel arches are cut all the way out.

1. Grown-up job: cut every solid line with a sharp knife and a metal ruler, in 2-3 light passes.
2. Score the dashed tread lines and grille bars HALF-deep only — never cut through.
3. Grown-up job: punch the two 5/16-inch axle holes in all 24 Body Cores and the small centre hole in all 36 Wheel Discs.



Step 3. Stack the 24-layer core



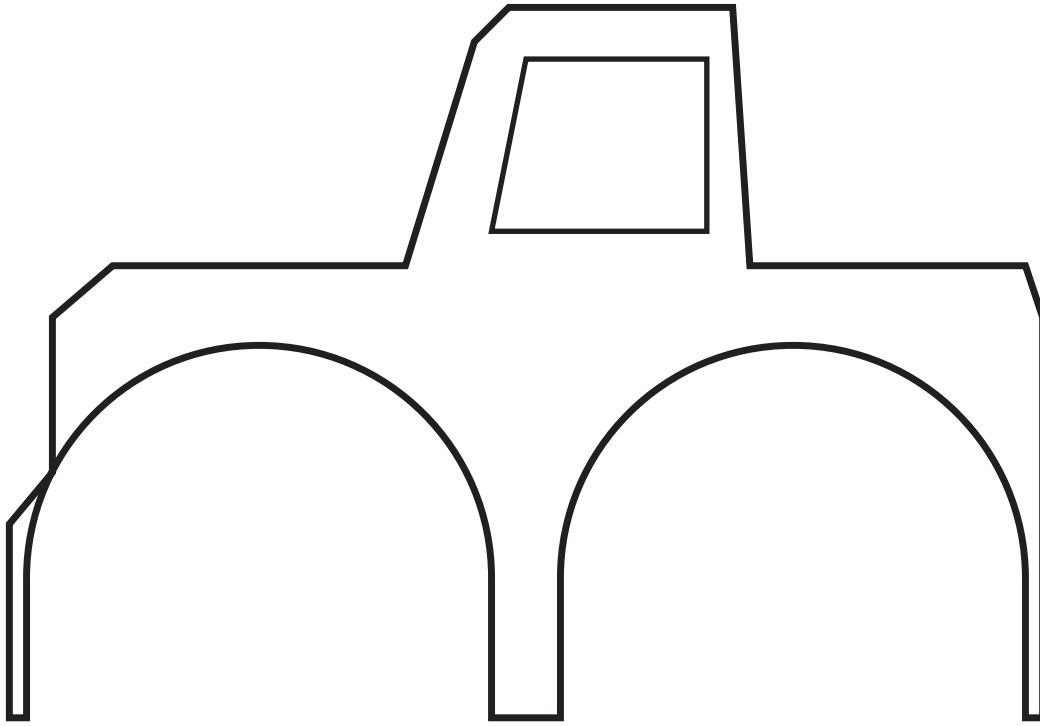
① Body Core ×24 — glued into one 3.6-inch-thick slab.

1. Slide both dowels through two Body Cores to line them up perfectly, then glue those two face to face.
2. Keep adding glued layers down the dowels until all 24 are stacked, spreading glue right to the edges.
3. Slide the dowels back out and press the slab flat under books overnight.

TIP: Wood glue is far stronger than hot glue here — the overnight wait is worth it.



Step 4. Skin the sides, add bumpers and lights

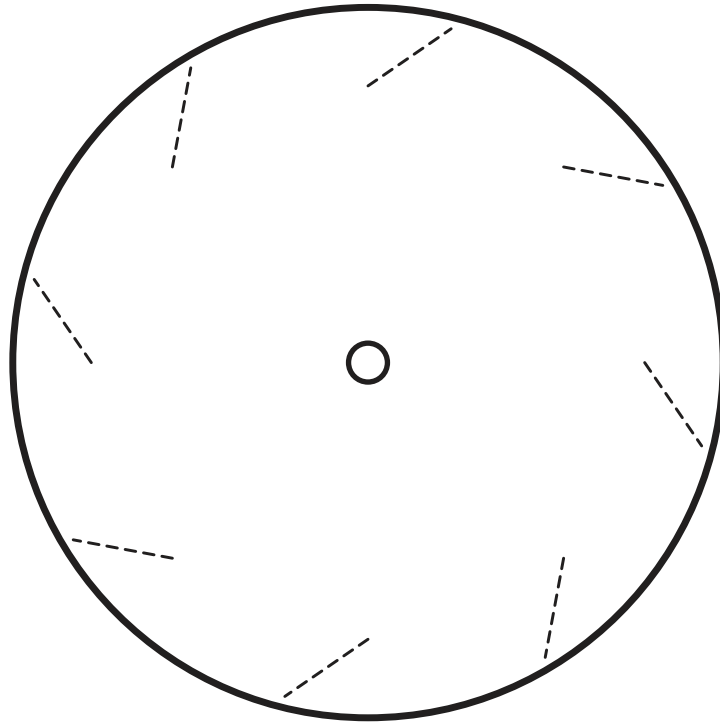


① Truck Side ×2 — one per face, arches centred on the axle tunnels.

1. Glue a Truck Side onto each face of the slab, matching the outline and centring each arch on an axle tunnel.
2. Glue a Bumper Plate across the nose and another across the tail, grille bars facing out.
3. Glue the Light Bar across the roof behind the windscreen.



Step 5. Build four fat wheels



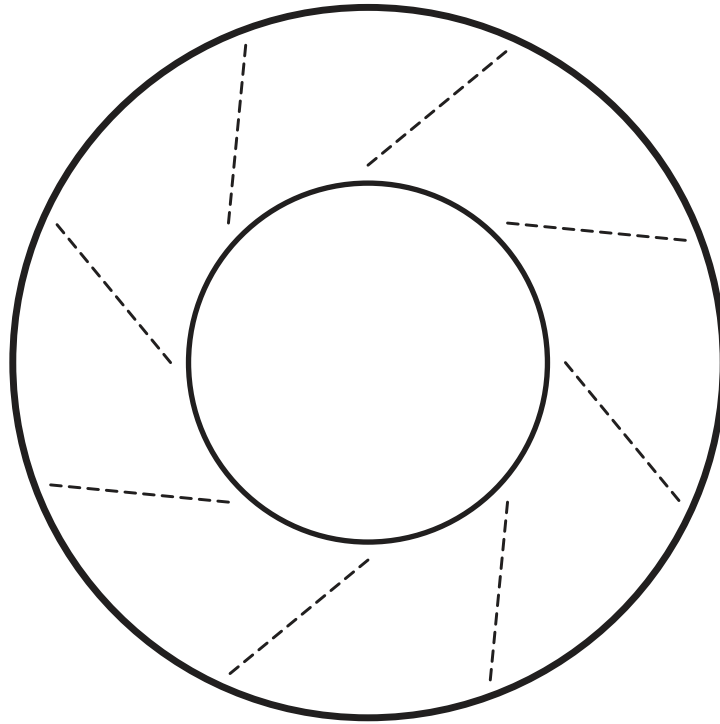
① Wheel Disc $\times 36$ — nine discs make one 1.35-inch-thick wheel.

1. Thread 9 Wheel Discs onto a spare dowel so the hub holes line up, gluing each disc to the next.
2. Glue a Wheel Face ring on the outside of each stack for the recessed-hub look.
3. Make four wheels, slide them off the dowel and let them dry.

TIP: Sand around each rim so the wheels roll round instead of lumpy.

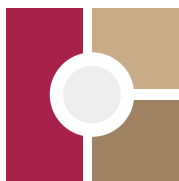


Step 6. Fit the axles and go



① Wheel Face ×4 — the outer ring of each finished wheel.

1. Push one dowel through the front tunnel and one through the rear — they must spin freely inside the body.
2. Grown-up job: glue the DOWEL ENDS only, then press a wheel onto each end. Never glue inside the tunnels.
3. Leave a dime's thickness of daylight between each wheel and the truck side, dry it, then paint flames and race it.



CARDBOARD STUDIO

MADE AT HOME, FOR HOME.

This template was designed in our family workshop. Print it, build it, smash it, rebuild it better. Share it with friends — and send us a photo of what you made!

BUILT WITH

Cardboard Studio

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